Midjourney Prompting

What it is: Midjourney is a popular AI image generator accessible via Discord (or their web app). It's known for its **artistic, highly detailed outputs** that often look great with minimal tweaking. Midjourney is a closed model (not open-source) and uses a lot of training data + in-house tuning to produce aesthetically pleasing images. It's excellent for concept art, stylized scenes, and more.

How to use it: In Discord, you type `/imagine prompt: ...` followed by your description. MJ has various **parameters** you can add at the end of the prompt, prefixed by `--`. Key ones for our use: `--ar` for aspect ratio, `--v` for model version (the latest is 5 or 6 depending on availability), `--style` or `--stylize` to control how much MJ's artistic flair is applied, `--quality` to trade-off speed vs detail, and `--seed` if you want deterministic results.

- **Basic prompt:** Similar to Stable Diffusion, describe the subject and style. MJ is very good at natural language, even more so than SD – you can be a bit more prose-like. *Example:* "an energetic **street dance battle** in New York City – shot from a low angle, neon graffiti on the walls, dramatic spotlights, **motion blur** on fast movements, in the style of an action movie still." This would yield a vibrant, dynamic image. Adding `--ar 9:16` ensures it's vertical.

- **Aspect Ratio:** Use `--ar width:height`. For vertical video content, `--ar 9:16` is ideal. You can also do `--ar 4:5` (Instagram portrait) or others, but 9:16 fills the phone screen. Note: Midjourney by default is square if not specified.

- **Stylize:** Midjourney has a concept of **Style/Stylize** (`--stylize` or `--s`). A higher stylize value (e.g. `--s 1000`) means MJ will inject more of its own artistic interpretation, sometimes deviating from prompt literalness to make it look cooler. A lower value (e.g. `--s 0` or `--s 50`) makes it adhere more strictly to your prompt details. For realistic outputs, you might lower stylize; for magical or painterly vibes, crank it up. The default is `--s 100` in many versions.

- **Quality:** `--q` (quality) can be 0.25, 0.5, 1 (default), or 2 (high). Higher quality takes longer and uses more credits but can add detail. For quick idea mockups, stick to 1; for final high-detail images, try 2.

- **Other handy params:** `--chaos` introduces more variability (good for creative, unexpected results if you want to see wild interpretations). `--seed` works similar to SD to reproduce results. You can also use image prompts (attach an image URL before your text prompt to influence style or content) – e.g. supply a photo of a character so the output stays similar. Midjourney also has `--no` for negative prompting, though it's somewhat limited (e.g. `--no text` to avoid text in image).

- **Example prompt (Midjourney):**
  ```
  /imagine prompt: **A makeup tutorial scene** – a beauty vlogger in a well-lit room, ring light reflection in her eyes, **soft pastel color palette**, product bottles on the table, blurred background. --ar 9:16 --v 5
  ```
  This would produce a polished image of a person doing a makeup tutorial, great for a cover image or cutaway in a beauty Reel. Note we didn't overdo modifiers; we let MJ's default understanding handle a lot. If the result shows a face that isn't perfect, we could add `--no extra_hands, --no disfigured` (though MJ is pretty good with faces compared to older SD). We could also add style cues like "in the style of a glossy magazine photo" for more glam.

- **Working with Midjourney outputs:** MJ gives 4 variations; you can upscale the one you like for full quality. If you need changes, you can either re-prompt with tweaks or use the variation buttons to riff on a chosen image. It's somewhat trial-and-error: don't be afraid to run multiple prompts. The upside

is MJ often gives *very cohesive* and artistically composed results even from simple prompts, thanks to its training and default "stylization".

- **Consistency considerations:** For video work, if you need the same character or style across multiple images, Midjourney can be a bit inconsistent (each run might create a new face or design). To mitigate this: use **image prompts** (generate one image you like, then feed it in the next prompt to get similar looking subjects), or use a **seed** to keep the noise initial condition the same. However, even with same seed and prompt, MJ might not guarantee identical characters across different descriptions. For more control in those cases, a custom Stable Diffusion model might work better, or use **Leonardo AI** which offers features for consistent characters.